Abbreviated Version of the Five Steps of Feeding Your Demons

Developed by **Tsultrim Allione**

Nine Relaxation Breaths

Close your eyes and keep them closed until the end of the fifth step. Take nine deep relaxation breaths with long exhalations. For the first three breaths, breathe in and imagine the breath is traveling to any tension in the body, then release this tension with the exhalation. For the second three breaths, inhale into any emotional tension, feel where you hold it in your body, and release it with the exhalation. And last, breathe into any mental tension, feeling where you hold nervousness, worries or mental blockages in your body and releasing them with the exhalation.

Motivation

Generate a heartfelt motivation to practice for the benefit of yourself and all beings.

The Five Steps

Step 1: Find the Demon

Decide which demon, god, or god-demon you are going to work with.

Locate where you hold it most strongly in your body and intensify the sensation.

Become aware of the qualities of the sensations in your body including:

- color
- texture
- temperature

Step 2: Personify the Demon and Ask It What It Needs

Personify this sensation as a figure with arms, legs, and eyes and see it facing you. If an inanimate object appears, imagine what it would look like if it were personified as some kind of animate being.

Notice:

- color
- skin surface
- gender
- size
- its character
- its emotional state
- the look in its eyes
- something about the demon you didn't see before

Ask the demon:

What do you want from me?
What do you need from met?
How will you feel if you get what you need?

Having asked the questions, immediately change places with the demon.

Step 3: Become the Demon

Face the chair or cushion you were seated on and become the demon, allowing yourself a little time to "sit in its shoes."

Notice how your normal self looks from the demon's point of view.

Now answer these three questions:

What I want from you is…
What I need from you is…
When my need is met, I will feel…

Step 4: Feed the Demon and Meet the Ally

Feeding the Demon

Come back to your original position. Take a moment to settle in and see the demon in front of you.

Dissolve your body into nectar that has the quality of the *feeling* that the demon would have if its need was satisfied (this is the answer to the third question in Step 3)

Feed the demon to its complete satisfaction, imagining the nectar entering the demon any way you wish. Keep feeding until complete satisfaction is reached (if the demon seems to be insatiable, then imagine how it would look if it were completely satisfied).

At this point you can go directly to step 5 or meet your ally.

Meeting the Ally

If there is a being present in place of the demon when you end the fourth step, ask this being if it is the ally. If it is not, invite an ally to appear. If the demon has dissolved completely then simply invite an ally to appear.

Notice all the details of the ally:

- color
- size
- the look in its eyes

Ask it one or all of these questions:

How will you help me?
How will you protect me?
What pledge or commitment do you make to me?
How can I gain access you?

Change places, become the ally, and answer the question(s) above, speaking as the ally.

I will help you by...
I will protect you by...
I pledge I will....
You can gain access to me by...

Return to your original position, then take a moment and feel the help and protection coming from the ally to you and then imagine the ally is dissolving into you. You and the ally dissolve into emptiness, which naturally takes you to the fifth step.

Step 5: Rest In Awareness

Rest in the state that is present when the ally dissolves into you and you dissolve into emptiness. Let your mind relax without creating any particular experience. Rest as long as you like without filling the space, not trying to make anything happen or rushing to finish.

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Feeding Your Demons is a process created and developed by Tsultrim Allione. Please do not teach this method to others without express written permission from Tsultrim Allione and Tara Mandala.

Feeding Your Demons Demon Tracking Form

Name:

Demon #:

Demon's Name:

Date:

Partner or solo:

Type of Demon:

1. ***Find the demon in your body: Where is it held in your body? (Sensation, color, texture, temperature)***

2. ***Personify the demon: What does it look like? (color, skin surface, gender, size, character, emotional state, the look in its eyes, notice something about the demon you didn't see before.)***

3. ***Become the demon: How does it feel to be the demon? What does it want? What does it need? How it will feel if it gets what it needs?***

4. *Feed the demon and meet the ally:*

Feeding the demon: What is the nectar like? What happens to it when you feed it?

Meeting the ally: Is the ally a figure that remains at the end of feeding the demons or is it a new figure that appears? What does it look like? How do you feel when you change places and become it? How will the ally help, serve and protect you? How does it feel to integrate the ally at the end?

5. *Rest: What is your experience after the ally dissolves into you and you dissolve into emptiness?*

After-thoughts, associations and realizations:

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SF Bay Tara Mandala
Practice Groups

To sign up for our monthly newsletter with practice schedule and special events, please send an email to: SFbayTaraMandala@yahoo.com

Marin Kapala Mandala Group
This group meets on the first and third Sunday morning of each month for Kapala Mandala practice: Prajña Paramita, Feeding the Demons, and Chöd. Open to all who have received Tsultrim's Prajña Paramita transmission. Bring your text and Chöd instruments. The new location is at the home of Elizabeth Navas, 1315 Grand Avenue in San Rafael. For more info, please email barbgay@earthlink.net

Davis/Sacramento Kapala Mandala Group
This group meets every other Friday for Kapala Mandala practice: Prajña Paramita, Feeding the Demons, and Chöd. Open to all who have received Tsultrim's Prajña Paramita transmission. Practice is from 9:30am to II:30am at different locations in Davis. For more details contact Chimae at 530 756-7170 or jtkapp@cal.net

Tahoe/Reno Kapala Mandala Group
This group meets on most Sunday afternoons to practice Prajña Paramita and Feeding the Demons. Open to all who have received Tsultrim's Prajña Paramita transmission. Locations in Reno vary from week-to-week. For details contact Polly Ryan at 530.320.7864 or pollyryanmft@yahoo.com

Marin Chöd Practice Group
We meet weekly on most Wednesday nights in San Anselmo. Open to all who have received Tsultrim's Chöd transmission or anyone wishing to receive the healing benefits of Chöd. Practice begins at 8:00pm at 115 Brookmead Court in San Anselmo. To RSVP and for more details, please contact Peter at (415) 453-6213 or email pjweinstein@yahoo.com.

Marin O-T-L Practice Group
This group meets twice monthly on Sundays for various traditional Vajrayana practices and study. The location is at the Tibetan Center for Compassion and Wisdom, at 160 Corte Madera Avenue in Mill Valley. For more details, please contact Christine at (415) 456-5435 or email christinesho@netscape.net

Monthly Chöd Practice in Marin
This group meets one Sunday morning at 10:30am each month for Chöd practice. Please email Laurie Bauer for details: lauriecpb@mac.com

For information on Kapala Mandala groups in the Los Angeles area, please contact julia@taramandala.org